

completing this is to end the long rule of the LDP. In order to prevent recurrences of corruption scandals, we will also work towards the strengthening of administrative supervision based on the introduction of an ombudsmen system, the promotion of the public management of elections, and the public disclosure of political funds.

7. Administrative Reform

We will revise the government's less than thorough reform of administration by carrying out the following reforms: 1) We will reduce public corporations by at least 20 percent. 2) As a guiding principle, we will abolish the local agencies of the central government, except for those already in place. 3) We will reconsolidate each of the types of deliberation councils. 4) We will reconsolidate the central ministries and agencies. 5) We will set the retirement age at 60 for government officials and work for their relocation. 6) We will reduce by at least 10 percent the amount given in subsidies. In addition, in order to open up administration, we will propose in the Diet a law to open up public documents (the public information law) at the initiative of third parties.

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TAGAWA, REPRESENTATIVE

36:60

1. Inflation

The public rates for electricity, gas, and water will be held down to low levels for amounts up to that used by the

average household. Rates for amounts over the average will be assessed at a progressively higher rate. We will employ administrative guidance with regard to oil products, fresh foods, and other items experiencing sharp increases in prices. Our basic policy towards prices is to foster liberal financial markets, liberalize interest rates, adjust the money supply, improve productivity, and enforce the Anti-Monopoly Law.

2. Welfare

We will guarantee welfare selectively by providing it to those who are really in need of it. In order to fulfill welfare without increasing taxes or insurance rates, it is necessary to promote the social solidarity of independent individuals such as by promoting homes with three generations living together and private insurance and pension systems. We will eliminate unneeded medical treatment, abolish differentials among pension systems, and establish a basic pension system. With regard to the age at which pension payments start, it is necessary to link it to the retirement age.

3. Education

We will change compulsory education from the current chopped up 6-3-3 system to a 6-5 system, and we will reform the education system to allow more freedom. In order to raise the affluence and the generosity of people, we must place importance on education that puts equal emphasis on knowledge, mind, and body. For example, the school curriculum can incorporate regular

programs of working in welfare institutions, refugee aid, overseas youth cooperatives, or other types of labor services into the last year of compulsory education. We will make universities easier to enter but harder from which to graduate.

4. Energy

In order to develop substitute sources of energy, we will promote nuclear power to produce electricity and our technological independence in nuclear power and undertake the development of the technology for soft types of energy, liquefied coal, and the import the technology develop coal. We will decide on a medium and long term plan for our supply of energy and work for its complete enactment, relying on a structure of aides directly responsible to the prime minister.

5. Security and Defense

Security is not simply based on the military; we must think about ensuring supplies of food and natural resources. We will work for an independent defense that is strictly for defense, as well as provide for military power based on the system of civilian control. We will build up a collective security arrangement with the Japan-U.S. Security Treaty as its core and fulfill our responsibility in accordance with our national resources. At the same time, we will work towards a healthy defense consciousness among the people.

6. Political Ethics

In order to supervise the conduct of politics and

administration, we will enact both a public information law and a law so that part of the political funds of political parties are provided by the national treasury. And it is necessary to revise the laws regulating political funds so that the expenditures and revenues of funds are publicly disclosed. In order to establish political ethics, it is necessary to publicly disclose the assets of politicians, strengthen the regulations holding a candidate jointly responsible for election law violations committed by his campaign manager or finance officer, and establish an independent body to investigate unethical conduct, as well as reorganize the regulations and sanctions regarding such conduct.

7. Administrative Reform

We will review the 101 public corporations and the 212 deliberation councils and based on the review a thorough reconsolidation is necessary. Administrative reform is not at the stage of discussion; it is time for decision and execution. In addition, we will carry out an investigative review of the ministries and carry out their reconsolidation. At the same time, we will reduce the number of government officials. Reductions will not be limited to just the administrative branch; they will also include the legislative branch. Thus, it is also necessary to reduce the number of dietmen.